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Police Chief Kochis says city technologically behind and not catching up anytime soon

Charlottesville Police Chief Mike Kochis, who just returned from a conference with local leaders and law enforcement from across the Commonwealth were sharing crime data with each other, and he told WINA's Morning News there's no question "we are so far behind in this city when it comes to technology and the way we aggregate and bring together data".

By [Jay Hart](#) September 18, 2025 10:27 am



Source: Contributed Photographer: Courtesy City of Charlottesville

CHARLOTTESVILLE, VA ([CVILLE RIGHT NOW](#)) – Charlottesville Police Chief Michael Kochis, who just returned from a conference with local leaders and law enforcement from across the Commonwealth were sharing crime data with each other, told WINA's Morning News there's no question, "we are so far behind in this city when it comes to technology and the way we aggregate and bring together data."

He said even though scrutiny of technological use by police — including the Flock license plate reader and Peregrine integrated data system – is not unique to Charlottesville, this community is indeed different.

"Warrenton's going through it with the Flock conversation up there," Kochis said of the town where he was chief before coming to Charlottesville. "There were people from Norfolk, Portsmouth, Richmond and other cities struggling with these things, and the data they're using, the systems they're using, one of which is Peregrine... they were connecting their data showing how many people served through the human services dashboard, looking at their crime dashboard, and connecting all this stuff."

While Kochis has said he has a job to do and will do it within the parameters of those charged with making decisions and funding initiatives, that doesn't mean he's not sometimes frustrated.

"I have my opinions about why we're that far behind, but I don't see us getting ahead anytime soon when it comes to that," he said.

Kochis noted Portsmouth, Norfolk, Richmond, Alexandria, and other localities that employ Peregrine and Flock technologies have progressive governments. In fact, some City Councilors at that conference expressed surprise that Charlottesville has suspended Peregrine for now and limited its Flock program.

"You know, I assume there's a reason why our policymakers feel that way," Kochis said. "And I don't want to discount it because people have lived experiences, people have a reason why they feel that way, and so I respect that. We're just different."

One important thing to remember, Kochis said, is "policing is very local."

"It's got to be unique to your individual community," he said.

Kochis talked about spending one day with Fairfax County's police chief and getting a look at their real-time crime center with hundreds of Flock cameras as they're preparing drone first-responders.

But Kochis said, "It really is about what your community expects, and that's how this works."



Jay Hart

Jay Hart is a news reporter with CvilleRightNow.com. Reach him by email at jhart@charlottesvilleradiogroup.com or call 434-977-6397.

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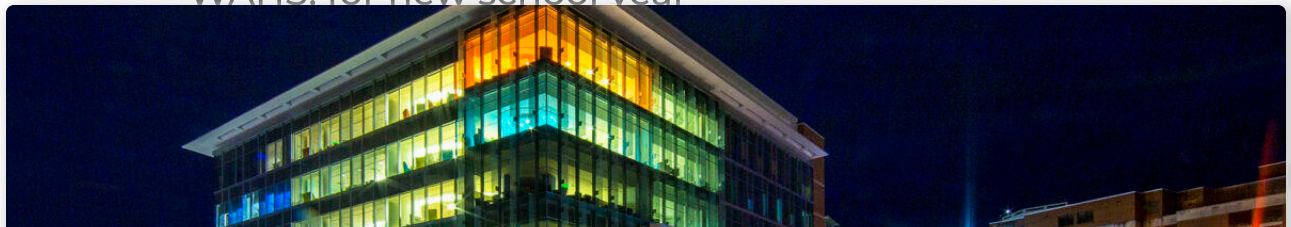
UVA

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Pres. Scott Beardsley says work is underway on new strategic vision for UVA

Beardsley told Cville Right Now the hope is to have the plan completed in about a year.

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Stories will be told throughout from families who've experienced UVA Health Children's care

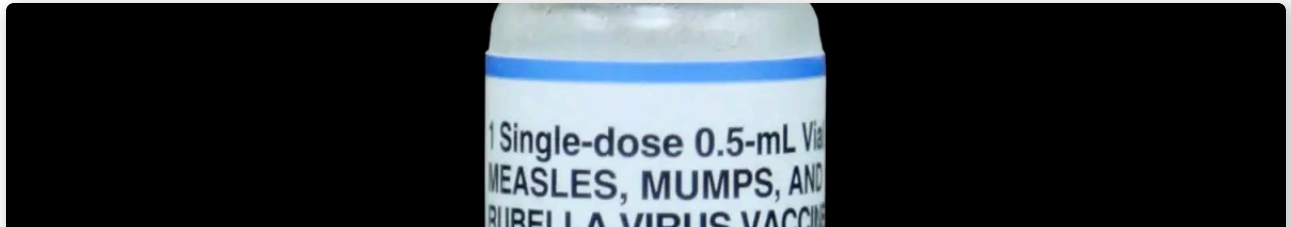


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Democrats ask Supreme Court to halt Virginia ruling against new voting maps

Democrats on Monday filed an emergency appeal with the U.S. Supreme Court seeking to halt a Virginia ruling invalidating a ballot measure that would have given their party an additional four winnable U.S. House seats.

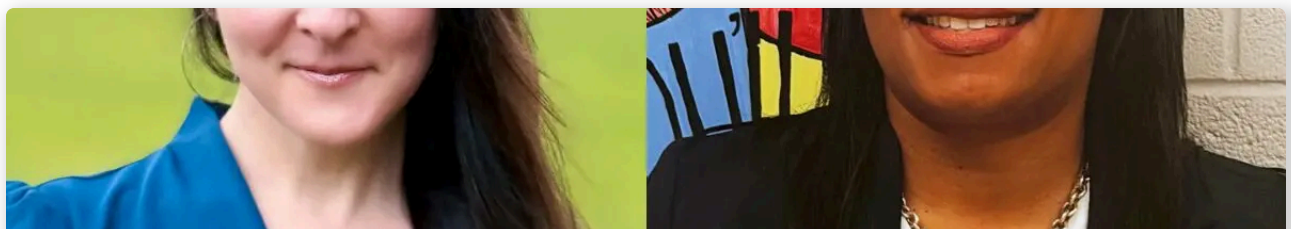


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The infected child had not traveled, spurring concern that there could be more, unreported cases locally.



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Western Albemarle High School appoints the former head of William Monroe Middle in Greene, while Agnor Elementary's assistant principal gets a promotion.



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1140 Rose Hill Drive Charlottesville, VA 22903
Tel: [434-220-2300](tel:434-220-2300)

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